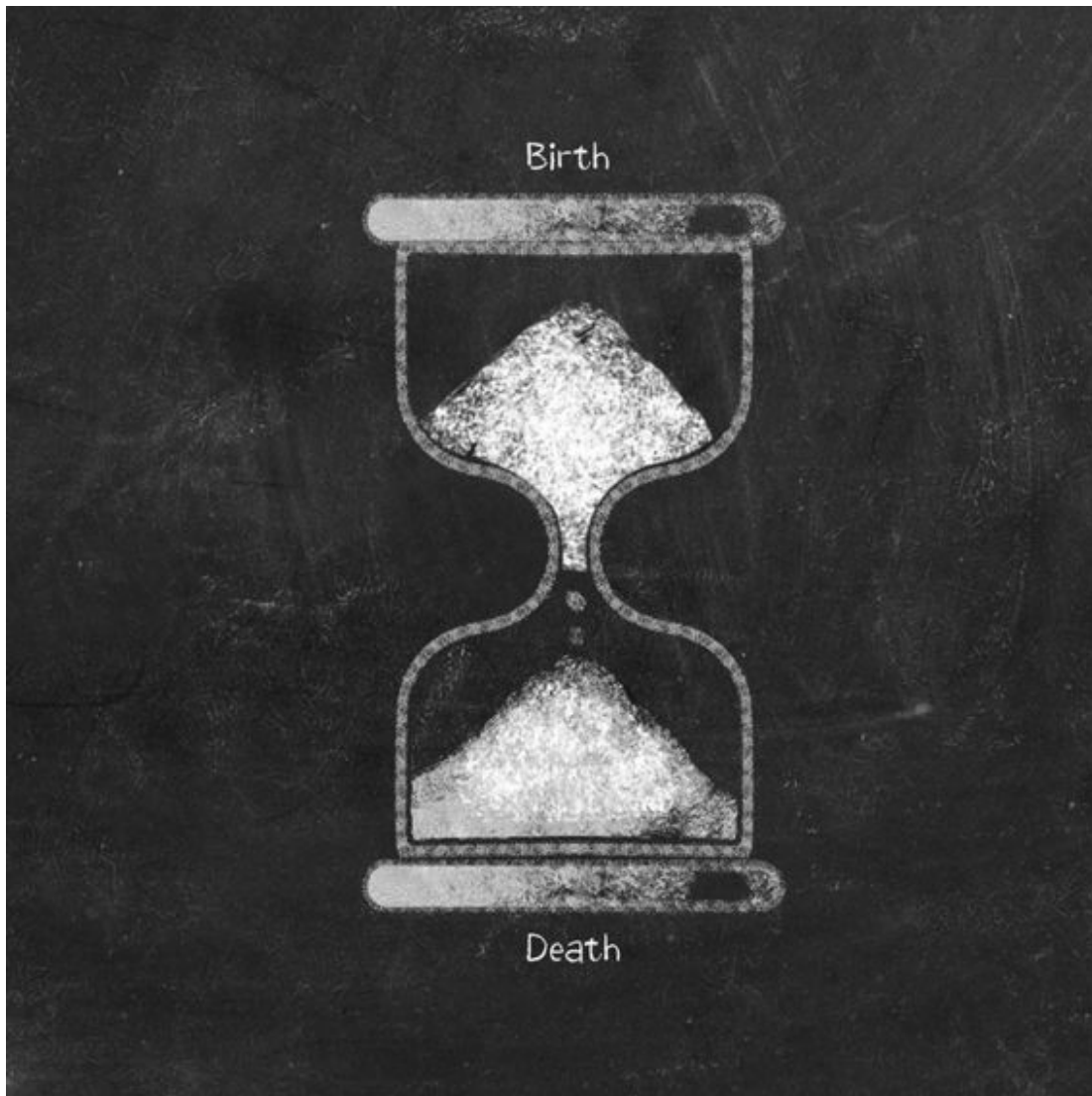


Heidegger: *Being and Time*



Martin Heidegger was drawn to philosophy by reading the work of Husserl, adopting the methods of phenomenology in his own examination of the nature of existence. Like Husserl, he cut out any discussion of the noumenal world in order to focus on the objects of human experience. Heidegger took this further, however, by pointing out in his book *Being and Time* (1927) that we are aware of our own existence, so it can be examined as part of the phenomenal world. Because it is an object of our experience, our being has to happen somewhere in space. It also exists in time and is inseparable from it – he concluded from our experience of existence having a past, present

and future, that being *is* time. Our lives are framed by time, from birth to death; we come to exist, become aware of our existence, but also become aware that it has an end. Our lives could simply be meaningless, as there are no objective certainties, so our task is to find significance in them. Awareness of death, which Heidegger says is the 'furthest horizon of our being', helps us understand our existence and live 'authentically'.